

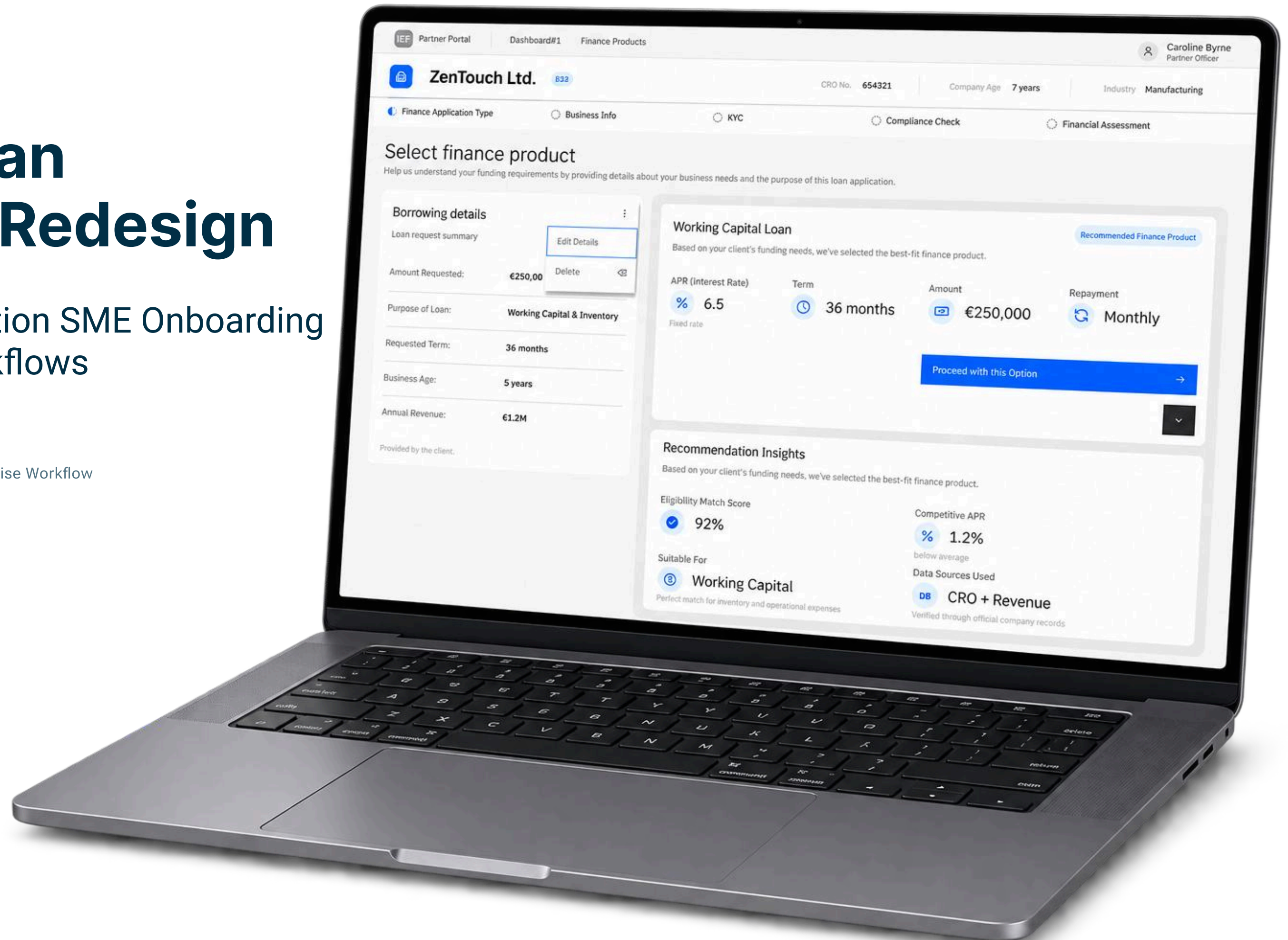


— B2B FINTECH · ENTERPRISE UX

B2B SME Loan Application Redesign

Streamlining High-Friction SME Onboarding
Risk Assessment Workflows

Product Design | B2B FinTech | Enterprise Workflow





— B2B FINTECH · ENTERPRISE UX

Redesigning the B2B SME Loan Application Portal

Transforming a high-friction, multi-step risk assessment workflow into an intuitive, progressive disclosure onboarding experience.

— PROJECT SNAPSHOT

ROLE

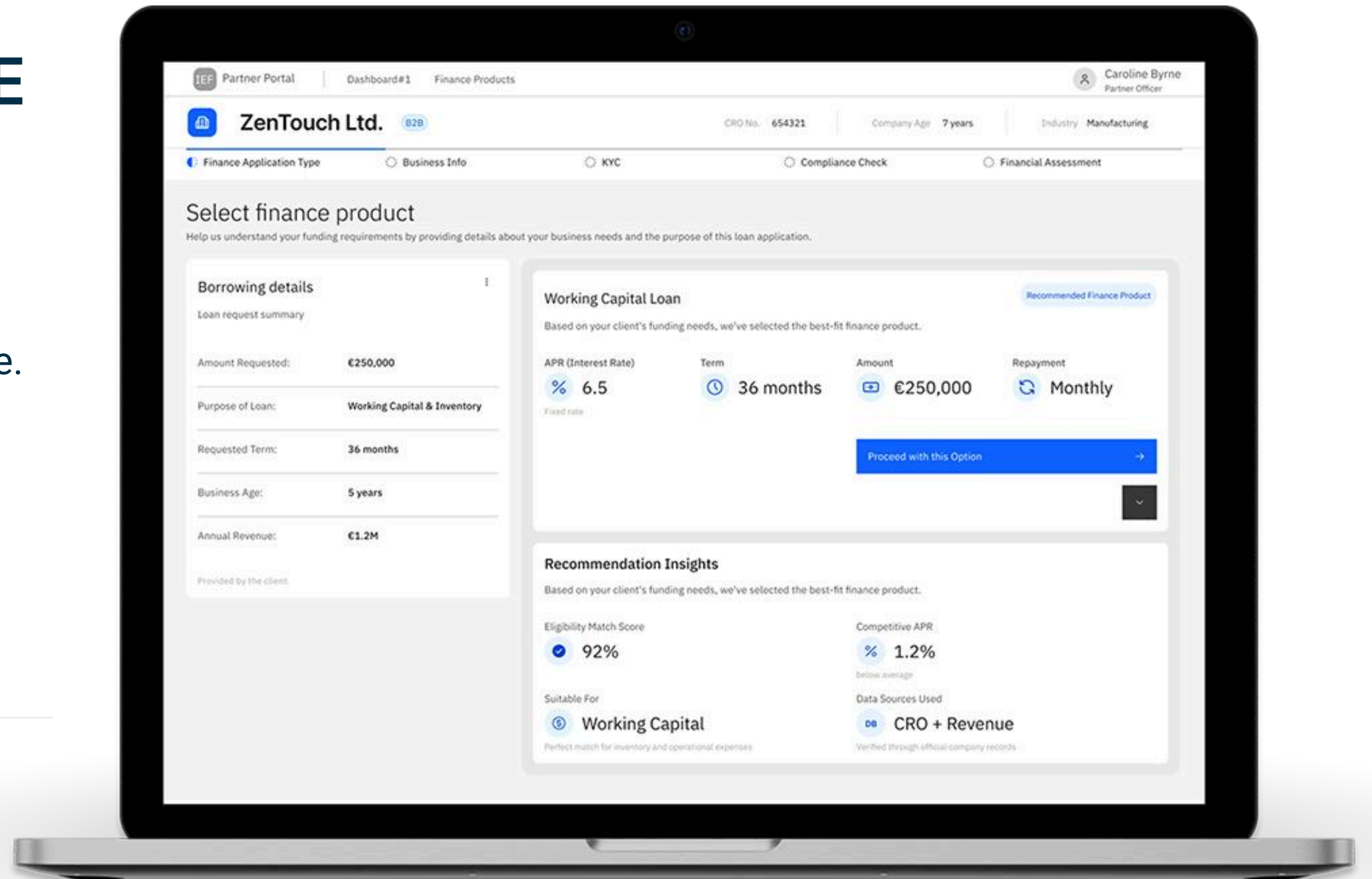
Senior Product Designer
Lead UX/UI Architecture

PLATFORM

Enterprise B2B SaaS
FinTech Portal

CORE IMPACT

Reduced onboarding completion time, eliminated form drop-off, and accelerated compliance review cycles.



— PROBLEM: High Cognitive Load & Abandonment Rates

- Small and medium enterprise (SME) applicants faced a dense, 25+ field form requiring complex financial data, KYC documentation, and multi-role approvals.
- **Friction Points:** High cognitive overload, unclear error state handling, lack of session-saving capability, and frequent session timeouts leading to a high drop-off rate during risk verification.

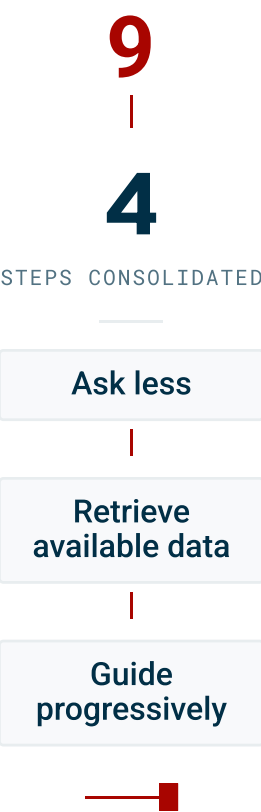
BEFORE

9-STEP WORKFLOW

Front-loaded data collection

LOAN APPLICATION	9- STEP WORKFLOW
01 BUSINESS INFORMATION	
Business Type	
CRO Number - Company Name	
VAT Number	
Company Size	
Annual Turnover	
02 APPLICATION TYPE	
Card Receipts (monthly)	
Non-card Receipts	
03 FUNDING REQUIREMENT	
Requested Amount	
Funding Purpose	
Repayment Term	
04 DECLARATIONS	
Director Details	
Beneficial Owners	
05 MANAGE SIGNATORIES	
Identity Document	
Contact Details	
Personal Address	
Company Role	
Signatory Position	
06 KYC	
Business Address	
Tax registration	
Personal ID	
Proof of address	
07 OPEN BANKING	
Bank connection	
08 FINANCIAL ASSESSMENT	
Financial Documentation	
Revenue statements	
09 SUBMIT	
Declaration	
● HIGH UPFRONT EFFORT	
Partners collected extensive client information before product suitability was clear.	

SYSTEM LOGIC
REDESIGNED



AFTER

4-STEP WORKFLOW

Progressive, system-assisted workflow

01 PARTNER INPUT

Essential inputs

Partner provides minimum information to initiate.

CRO NumberBusiness TypeRequested Amount

SYSTEM ACTION

Retrieve available business data

02 SYSTEM ACTION

Early guidance

System retrieves available data and recommends a suitable finance product.

RECOMMENDED PRODUCT

Suitable finance productMatch identified

03 PARTNER REVIEW

Review retrieved data

Partner reviews retrieved information and resolves only exceptions or mismatches.

Company information✓

Directors✓

Registered addressAction required

Only exceptions require attention

04 PROGRESSIVE COMPLETION

Complete application

KYC, documents, financial assessment and submission progressively complete the application.

KYCSupporting documentsFinancial assessmentSubmit



— DESIGN HYPOTHESIS · SYSTEM LOGIC

System-Assisted Data & Early Guidance

Reorganizing the application flow to reduce unnecessary partner input, retrieve available data automatically, and provide guidance earlier in the process.

— KEY PILLARS

01

Progressive Disclosure

Restructuring the dense 9-step application into four logically grouped stages, while requesting additional partner input only when it becomes relevant or requires review.

9 STEPS —> 4 STAGES

02

System-Assisted Validation

Automatically retrieving and validating available business data, while asking partners to review only information that is missing or requires attention.

RETRIEVE —> VALIDATE —> REVIEW

03

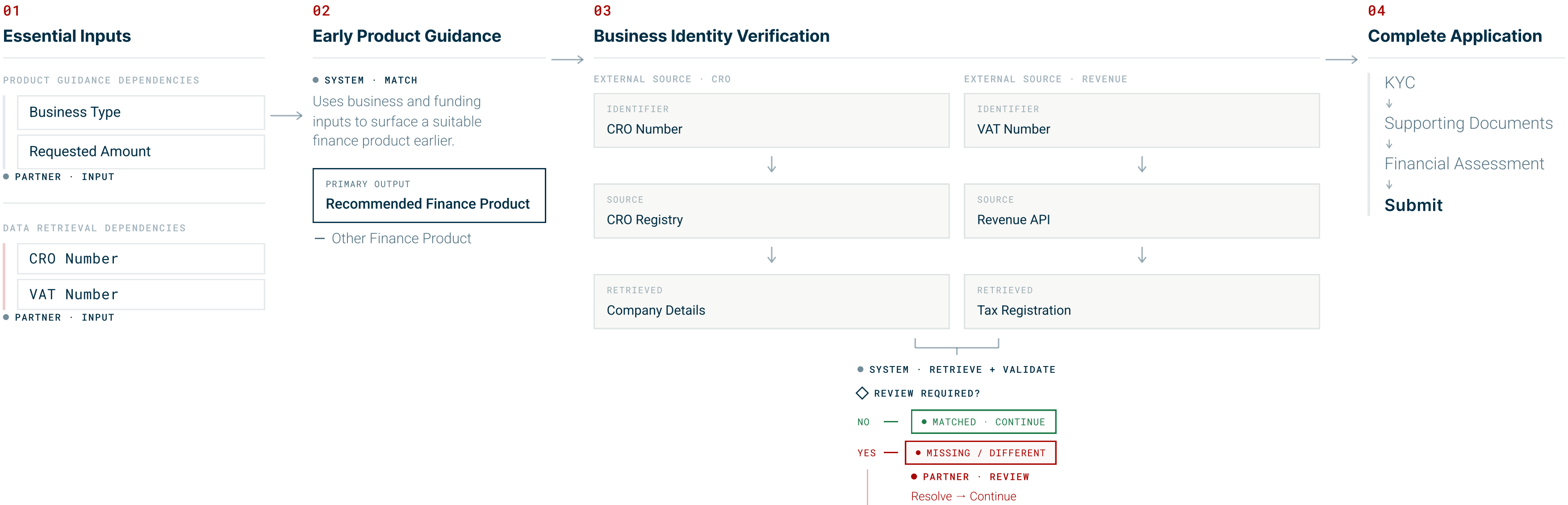
Multi-Role Alignment

Designing distinct views for SME applicants with clear progress and minimal friction, and compliance officers with faster risk assessment.



Restructuring the Application Architecture

Essential inputs now trigger product guidance, external data retrieval and conditional review throughout the application.





PARTNER EXPERIENCE

Streamlining the Partner Application Experience

The redesigned flow gives partners clearer progress, earlier product guidance and more context for confident decision-making.

01

Clear Progress Structure

A simplified application structure keeps the current stage visible and helps partners understand what remains before submission.

PARTNER · REVIEW

Review or edit client-provided information without leaving the flow.

02

Early Product Guidance

Initial business and funding information is used to surface a recommended finance product before the partner progresses through the remaining application.

03

Contextual Transparency

Recommendation insights expose the factors and data sources behind the suggested product, giving partners more context before they proceed.

IEF Partner Portal

Dashboard#1

Finance Products

Caroline Byrne

Partner Officer

ZenTouch Ltd.

B2B

CRO No. 654321

Company Age 7 years

Industry Manufacturing

Finance Application Type

Business Info

KYC

Compliance Check

Financial Assessment

Select finance product

Help us understand your funding requirements by providing details about your business needs and the purpose of this loan application.

Borrowing details

Loan request summary

Edit Details

Delete

Amount Requested:

€250,00

Purpose of Loan:

Working Capital & Inventory

Requested Term:

36 months

Business Age:

5 years

Annual Revenue:

€1.2M

Provided by the client.

Working Capital Loan

Recommended Finance Product

Based on your client's funding needs, we've selected the best-fit finance product.

APR (Interest Rate)

% 6.5

Fixed rate

Term

36 months

Amount

€250,000

Repayment

Monthly

Proceed with this Option

Recommendation Insights

Based on your client's funding needs, we've selected the best-fit finance product.

Eligibility Match Score

92%

Competitive APR

% 1.2%

below average

Suitable For

Working Capital

Perfect match for inventory and operational expenses

Data Sources Used

CRO + Revenue

Verified through official company records

Other Finance Products

Alternative finance options that may suit your client

Asset Finance

Alternate

Equipment & machinery funding

Interest Rate (APR)

7.2%

Amount:

€100,000

Term:

48 months

Invoice Finance

Alternate

Cash flow against receivables

Interest Rate (APR)

7.2%

Amount:

€100,000

Term:

48 months

06



Turning Data Validation into Actionable Review

Retrieved business data is verified by the system, while partner attention is directed to information that requires review.

01
System-Assisted Verification
Company and tax information is retrieved from CRO and Revenue, reducing the amount of business data partners need to verify manually.

- SYSTEM · RETRIEVE
- SYSTEM · VALIDATE

02
Issues Surfaced in Context
Only information that needs attention is highlighted, helping partners identify what requires review before continuing.

- PARTNER · REVIEW

03
Guided Issue Resolution
Conflicting records are shown side by side with their source, allowing the partner to understand the mismatch and choose how to resolve it without leaving the application.

- PARTNER · RESOLVE

IEF Partner Portal | Dashboard#1 Finance Products

Caroline Byrne Partner Officer

ZenTouch Ltd. B2B

CRO No. 654321 Company Age 7 years Industry Manufacturing

Finance Application Type Business Info KYC Compliance Check Financial Assessment

Business Information

Review company information retrieved from CRO and tax records. Resolve any issues before continuing.

Review Summary

Review required 2 issues need your attention before continuing.

Issue 1 Registered address change View issue →

Issue 2 Director information mismatch View issue →

Company Details

Company Name: ZenTouch Ltd.

CRO Number: 6724XXX

Company Type: Limited Company

Registered Address: Shannon Industrial Estate, Co. Clare Issue 1 View Issue →

Directors (2): Michael Carter, John Murphy Issue 2 View Issue →

Company Status: Active

Information retrieved automatically from CRO. Last updated 2 hours ago.

Tax Registration Match

Tax Registration Number: 3825XXXXA

VAT Status: Registered

Business Activity: Manufacturing

Revenue Registration Status: Active

Last Verified: 14 Nov 2025

Information retrieved automatically from Revenue. Last updated 2 hours ago.

Issue Resolution

Resolve required issues before continuing.

Issue 1 Registered address change detected Action required

CRO records show a different registered address from the current application record. Choose which address should be used before continuing.

SOURCE	REGISTERED ADDRESS
Current application record	Unit 5, Industrial Park, Co. Clare
CRO record Official registry	Shannon Industrial Estate, Co. Clare

Use current address

Use CRO address

Issue 2 Director information mismatch Action required

Back

Next

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Extending Carbon for Data Review

01 · STRUCTURED LIST | DATA VALIDATION STATES

• VERIFIED

Company Details		Match
Company Name:	ZenTouch Ltd.	
CRO Number:	6724XXX	
Company Type:	Limited Company	
Registered Address:	Shannon Industrial Estate, Co. Clare	
Directors (2):	Michael Carter, John Murphy	
Company Status:	Active	
Information retrieved automatically from CRO. Last updated 2 hours ago.		

• REVIEW REQUIRED

Company Details		
Company Name:	ZenTouch Ltd.	
CRO Number:	6724XXX	
Company Type:	Limited Company	
Registered Address:	Shannon Industrial Estate, Co. Clare	Issue 1 View Issue →
Directors (2):	Michael Carter, John Murphy	
Company Status:	Active	
Information retrieved automatically from CRO. Last updated 2 hours ago.		

↓ USER ACTION → VIEW ISSUE → REVEAL RESOLUTION CONTEXT

STRUCTURED LIST	DATA ROW	CONDITIONAL UI
validationState →	state →	Match → verified
verified /	default / issue	Issue tag + View issue
reviewRequired		→
		reviewRequired

Reusable states and composite patterns create a consistent path from verified data to exception review and resolution.

02 · ACCESSIBILITY SPEC | SEMANTIC STATES, NOT COLOR ALONE

The issue state is never communicated through color alone. Each exception combines five distinct layers.

ISSUE STATE – FIVE REQUIRED LAYERS		
1. Issue 1 tag		Neutral cross-reference, no color dependency
2. Yellow row + border		Warning context, combined with written label
3. "Action required"		Explicit status for assistive technology
4. View issue link		Keyboard-focusable, 2px focus outline
5. Resolution panel link		Direct connection to the issue panel

CONTRAST RATIOS

Tag label 12px 13.77:1 WCAG AAA	Body text 14px 15.3:1 WCAG AAA
Link on white 8.59:1 WCAG AAA	Yellow row text 6.2:1 WCAG AA



Extending Carbon for Resolution

Reusable states and composite patterns create a consistent path from verified data to exception review and resolution.



Issue 1Registered address change detected

Action required

● EXPANDED expanded = true



Issue 1Registered address change detected

Action required



CRO records show a different registered address from the current application record. Choose which address should be used before continuing.

SOURCE	REGISTERED ADDRESS
Current application record	Unit 5, Industrial Park, Co. Clare
CRO record Official registry	Shannon Industrial Estate, Co. Clare

Use current address

Use CRO address

01 Status

02 Context

03 Source Comparison

04 Resolution Action



— CONSTRAINTS & TRADE-OFFS

Designing for Real-World Constraints

How technical and regulatory assumptions shaped the proposed experience.

	CONSTRAINT CONSIDERED	DESIGN RESPONSE	USER BENEFIT
01	External data and document checks may not return instantly.	Use asynchronous processing with clear progress indicators and real-time status updates.	Partners can continue working without wondering whether the system has stalled.
02	CRO, Revenue and banking data may conflict with existing records.	Flag only affected rows and connect each row to its corresponding issue panel.	Partners can identify and resolve mismatches without reviewing the entire application.
03	KYC and GDPR requirements demand clear evidence and user control.	Show the data source, explain why action is required and request confirmation before records are updated.	Partners can make informed decisions with greater confidence.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE I treated constraints as interaction requirements—not reasons to expose backend complexity to the user.



DESIGN OUTCOMES

Validating the Hypothesis Through Design Outcomes

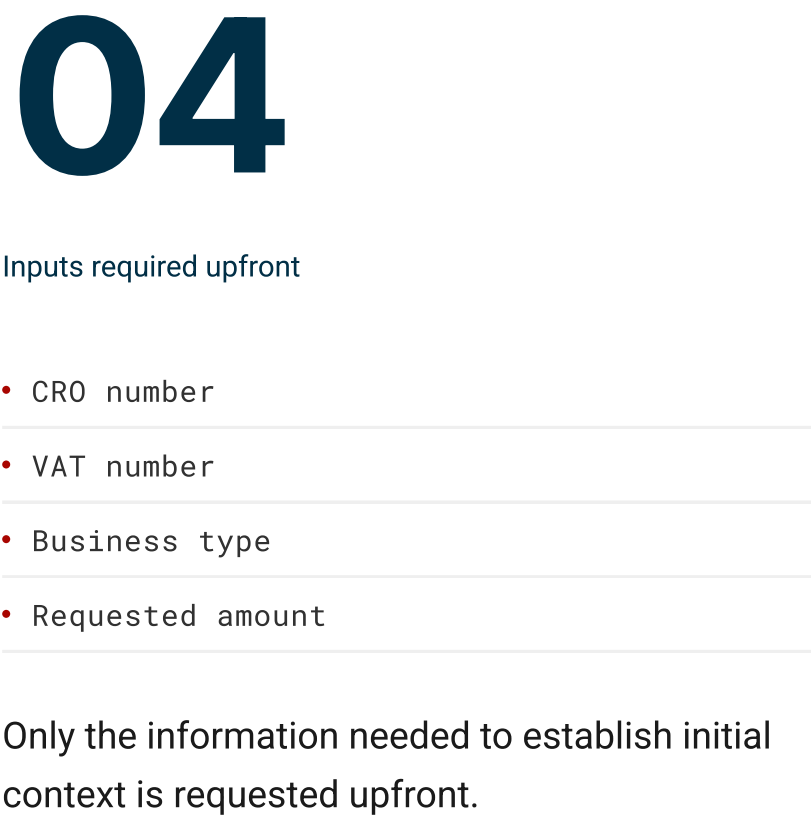
The redesigned workflow reduced structural complexity, minimized upfront partner input, and shifted available business-data retrieval to the system.

WORKFLOW STAGES

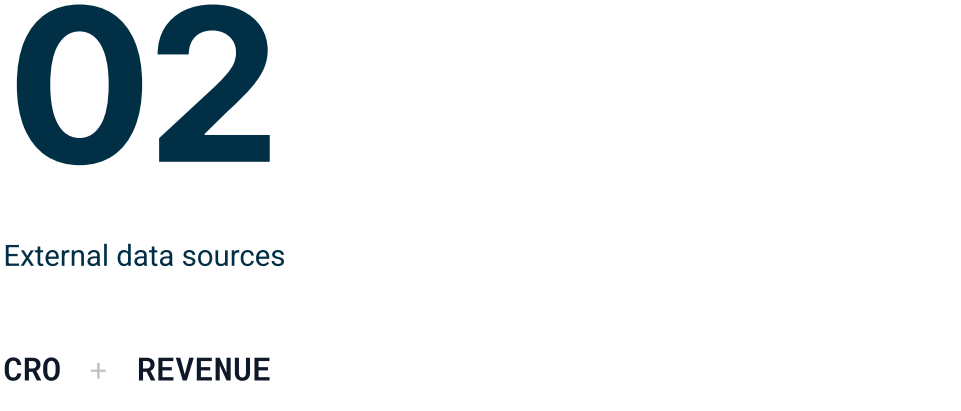


Nine front-loaded stages were reorganized into four logically grouped stages.

ESSENTIAL INPUTS



CONNECTED SOURCES



POST-LAUNCH METRICS TO VALIDATE

Completion rate ↑ Time to submit ↓ Manual data entry ↓ Issue-resolution rate ↑

These are proposed success measures for the prototype, not production results.



— REFLECTION

Reflection & Scalability Lessons

What the redesign taught me about simplifying complex workflows, introducing automation responsibly, and validating system-assisted experiences.

WORKFLOW ARCHITECTURE

Complexity can be structured without hiding necessary information.

Progressive disclosure helped restructure the dense 9-stage application into four logically grouped stages, while requesting additional information only when it became relevant.

SYSTEM + HUMAN

Automation works best when ambiguity remains visible.

The system can retrieve, validate and compare available business information, but conflicting records should be surfaced for partner review and client confirmation

NEXT ITERATION

Automation works best when ambiguity remains visible.

Exploring AI-assisted document pre-parsing to auto-fill financial figures directly from uploaded PDF tax returns.

***Designing for enterprise complexity is not about removing information.
— it is about revealing the right information at the right moment.***